

Fewer empty chairs, less chasing

A cancellation starts a round of spreadsheet checks and texts. Group messages can leave two clients expecting the same appointment.

The goal

Fill at least half of those openings with less repeated checking.

8-12

cancellations inside 48 hours
in a typical week

50%

target, not a measured result

An opening, one invitation at a time

01	02	03	04
Review the fit	Offer in order	Wait for a reply	Finish in Square
Lena or Carla checks service, stylist capability, and general availability.	The earliest matching request gets the first chance. Only one active offer per client.	A timely YES confirms. NO or a missed deadline moves the offer to the next client.	Staff add the booking, adjust any later appointment, then mark Square updated.

15 minutes today

1 hour for a later date

Every offer ends at least one hour before the appointment.

Staff can see what needs attention

A question from a client

Unclear replies appear prominently with the deadline. Staff follow up while the clock keeps running.

A booking made elsewhere

Staff can cancel an open offer and send an apology. If already confirmed, staff resolve the conflict personally.

Declines and timeouts stay in history. Requests remain on the list until filled or removed.

A failed text or a late YES

Failed delivery flags staff and moves on. A late YES cannot claim an expired offer.

An interruption

Temporal remembers the offer and its deadline. Restarting resumes saved progress without sending the same offer again.

What the prototype does today

Working in the demo

Reviewed queues and one active offer per client. Clear outcomes, reply alerts, and a separate Square checkoff.

Offers go out 9 AM to 7 PM Central, Monday through Saturday. Late-night cancellations wait for the next business morning. Remaining reply time carries over.

Simulated or excluded

Texts use fictional clients and a simulator. No real SMS leaves the app.

Square and Google Sheets are not connected. Staff enter requests and report outside bookings manually.

This is a local demo. Secure staff access and a live messaging service still need setup.

A rehearsal, then a small pilot

Proposed next step

Book 30 minutes with Lena and Carla to rehearse an acceptance, a late reply, an unclear reply, an outside booking, and an overnight cancellation.

Before real clients

Agree on the texts and the Square handoff.
Set up secure staff access and live SMS,
then test delivery and opt-outs.

If the rehearsal works

Try one stylist's haircut openings for two weeks. Track fill rate, staff time, and booking conflicts. Aim for at least 50% filled and no competing promises.